

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In the damp hollows of the southern Appalachians, the fungus *Panellus stipticus* emits a faint green light after _____ hikers sometimes mistake the glow for distant lanterns.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: dark,

B: dark;

C: dark

D: dark; and

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses. A comma alone creates a splice; no punctuation creates a run-on. A semicolon joins them correctly. Adding 'and' after a semicolon is redundant--the semicolon already does the conjunction's job.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The murals of painter Alma Reyes Cortes, celebrated for their layered depictions of market life in Oaxaca, _____ now housed in three museums across southern Mexico.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: are

B: have been

C: has been

D: were

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: strip the appositive ('celebrated for...Oaxaca'). The subject is 'murals' (plural), and 'now' signals present tense. Only 'are' is plural + present. 'Have been' is tempting but pairs awkwardly with 'now housed.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Novelist Perpetua Andrade published her story collection *The Tin Orchard* in 1954. Decades later, in 2003, a stage adaptation _____ its premiere at a small theater in Wellington, New Zealand.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: makes

B: is making

C: had made

D: made

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'in 2003' is a completed past event--simple past is required. 'Had made' is tempting but past perfect needs an earlier-past reference point. 'Makes' and 'is making' are present tense, wrong for 2003.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Rising above the salt flats of the Pampilla basin in Chile's Atacama Desert, the Torre Blanca outcrop is composed largely of ulexite, a soft mineral that _____ delicate fibrous crystals under slow evaporation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: forming

B: to form

C: forms

D: has been forming

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative clause 'that _____' needs a finite verb. 'Forming' and 'to form' are non-finite and create fragments. 'Forms' is the simple present finite verb that matches the singular 'mineral.' 'Has been forming' is finite but implies an ongoing process not supported by context.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Under the 2019 groundwater accord in the fictional Serena Valley, each participating village submitted _____ own water-use records to a regional review board before any new wells could be approved.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: its

B: their

C: it's

D: there

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'each' makes the subject singular, requiring 'its.' 'Their' is tempting because multiple villages exist, but 'each' treats them individually. 'It's' = 'it is' (contraction, not possessive). 'There' is an adverb, not a pronoun.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Perched at 4,100 meters on a ridge with famously stable air, the Cerro Lumen Observatory owes _____ exceptionally sharp images less to its telescopes than to the thin, dry atmosphere above them.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: it's

B: their

C: its

D: its'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the observatory (singular) possesses the images, so a singular possessive pronoun is needed. 'Its' is the possessive; 'it's' = 'it is'; 'its'' is not a real English form. 'Their' is plural--wrong for a single observatory.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Why do some desert wildflowers bloom only once after decades of _____ answer lies in seed coatings that dissolve solely under rare, sustained rainfall.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: dormancy, the

B: dormancy? The

C: dormancy the

D: dormancy. The

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the sentence beginning with 'Why' is a question and must end with a question mark. After the question mark, 'The' starts a new declarative sentence (capitalized). A comma creates a splice; a period ignores the question; no punctuation creates a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The handwritten recipes, along with a set of annotated banquet menus, _____ donated to the culinary archive at Halloway College in 1998 by the family of chef Odile Ferrant.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has been

B: is

C: was

D: were

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'along with' is parenthetical--it does NOT join subjects. The true subject is 'recipes' (plural). 'Were' is the only plural past-tense option. 'Was' is singular; 'has been' and 'is' are singular and wrong tense for '1998.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Every spring, the gray cranes of the Vesle Marsh _____ to the same nesting hummocks, guided, researchers suspect, by landmarks memorized during their first migration.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has returned

B: will have returned

C: returning

D: return

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Every spring' signals a habitual present action--simple present tense. 'Return' matches the plural 'cranes.' 'Has returned' is singular + present perfect (wrong for habitual). 'Returning' is a participle that creates a fragment.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The legacy of the Portuguese Empire, which once linked ports on four continents, remains audible in Portuguese-speaking Brazil. Contrast Brazil with the trading post of Hirado, Japan, whose commercial ties to Portugal were severed in _____ the latter's connection to the empire is now so faint that Portuguese is rarely heard there today.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1639;

B: 1639 and

C: 1639:

D: 1639,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses border the blank. A semicolon correctly joins them. A comma creates a splice. A colon is tempting but the second clause does not define or list--it contrasts. 'And' without punctuation creates a run-on after a date.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The clavilyre--a nineteenth-century hybrid of zither and hammered _____ was assembled by Belgian instrument maker Henriette Doorn from parts salvaged from two damaged concert instruments.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: dulcimer,
- B: dulcimer;
- C: dulcimer--
- D: dulcimer:

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the opening '--' after 'clavilyre' must be closed with a matching '--' after 'dulcimer.' Dashes work in pairs to set off parenthetical info. A comma, semicolon, or colon would mismatch the opening dash.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: According to a five-year monitoring effort, the concentration of microplastic particles in the deepest sediments of Lake Verian _____ risen even as surface concentrations have declined, suggesting that fragments settle faster than they degrade.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have

B: has

C: are

D: were

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: ignore 'particles' and 'sediments'--they are inside prepositional phrases. The head subject is 'concentration' (singular), requiring 'has.' 'Have' is the classic trap, attracted by the nearby plural nouns.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: As part of her effort to chart undiscovered hydrothermal fields in the fictional Meridian Trench, oceanographer Talia Brandt deployed a towed sonar platform. The vessel _____ the seafloor, which harbored vent systems first detected only a decade earlier, followed transects that guaranteed a mapped corridor two kilometers wide on every pass.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: surveys

B: surveying

C: was surveying

D: surveyed

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick (Hard-level sentence): 'surveying' is a present participle modifying 'vessel'--it acts as a reduced relative clause ('The vessel [that was] surveying the seafloor...followed transects'). 'Surveyed' would create two finite verbs ('surveyed...followed') with no conjunction. 'Was surveying' also creates two main verbs. 'Surveys' is present tense in a past narrative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Between 2011 and 2016, textile artist Rosalind Mbeki completed three residencies at coastal studios in Mozambique, Portugal, and Wales. During _____ residencies, she produced the woven triptychs that later anchored her first retrospective.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: this
- B: that
- C: these
- D: one

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'three residencies' is plural and specific (already mentioned), so the demonstrative must be plural and proximal: 'these.' 'This' and 'that' are singular. 'One' doesn't match 'residencies' (plural).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In a 2021 field study, biologists Mara Okafor and Liesl Van Dyk tracked seed dispersal by fruit bats across a fragmented forest reserve. The _____ findings indicated that bats carried viable seeds nearly twice as far as earlier models had predicted.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: researchers'

B: researcher's

C: researchers

D: researchers's

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: two biologists = plural. Plural possessive of a regular noun = add apostrophe after the s: 'researchers'.' 'Researcher's' is singular possessive (one person). 'Researchers' without apostrophe is just a plural noun, not possessive. 'Researchers's' is not standard.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Determined to reduce spoilage during the humid harvest months, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: the village's cold-storage sheds were redesigned around passive ventilation by the cooperative's engineers.

B: redesigning the cold-storage sheds around passive ventilation was the approach the cooperative's engineers took.

C: the cold-storage sheds' redesign around passive ventilation was carried out by the cooperative's engineers.

D: the cooperative's engineers redesigned the village's cold-storage sheds around passive ventilation.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Determined to reduce spoilage' must modify the subject of the main clause. Only D starts with 'the cooperative's engineers'--a human agent who can be 'determined.' The other options start with inanimate nouns (sheds, redesigning, redesign), creating a dangling modifier.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Shorebird Stewards program trains volunteers to monitor plover nests along the estuary, log hatch dates in a shared database, and _____ predators by installing low wire exclosures around vulnerable clutches.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: deter

B: deterring

C: deterred

D: to have deterred

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the list after 'to' is: 'monitor...log...and _____. ' Each item must be a bare infinitive to match. 'Deter' completes the parallel structure. 'Deterring' (gerund), 'deterred' (past), and 'to have deterred' (perfect infinitive) all break the pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Coastal grain mills in northwestern France adopted turbine power unusually early; the Landry mill in Brittany installed its first turbine in _____ whereas inland mills, lacking reliable river access, waited decades to modernize.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1873, for instance;

B: 1873 for instance,

C: 1873; for instance,

D: 1873, for instance,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'for instance' is a parenthetical--it needs commas on both sides. The clause continues with 'whereas,' so no semicolon should interrupt. '1873, for instance,' correctly embeds the parenthetical. A semicolon before 'whereas' would wrongly break the contrast clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: With sustained gradients exceeding 20 percent near its summit, the Passo di Vellei is one alpine _____ amateur cyclists frequently underestimate, especially in early spring, when meltwater slicks the switchbacks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: climb, which

B: climb that

C: climb in which,

D: climb, that

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the clause 'amateur cyclists frequently underestimate' is essential--it defines WHICH climb. Essential clauses use 'that' with no comma. 'Which' with a comma is for non-essential info. 'Climb, that' mixes the two rules incorrectly.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: By the time census enumerators reached the upland hamlets of the fictional Corvane district in October 1911, most families _____ for the seasonal harvest camps, leaving the official population counts sharply and misleadingly low.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have already left

B: already leave

C: had already left

D: will have left

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'By the time X happened' signals that one past event preceded another. Past perfect ('had left') marks the earlier event. 'Have left' is present perfect (wrong for 1911). 'Already leave' is present tense. 'Will have left' is future perfect.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In hydrology, "measured rainfall" and "modeled rainfall" are often treated as interchangeable, a convenience that conceals real gaps. In 2023, a team led by statistician Ruben Alcaraz built a framework to quantify those gaps. Reconciling the two quantities--whether over deserts, deltas, or icefields--_____ among the team's primary aims.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: were

B: having been

C: was

D: being

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is 'Reconciling the two quantities'--a gerund phrase, which is always grammatically singular. Ignore 'quantities,' 'deserts,' 'deltas,' and 'icefields'--they are inside the phrase. Singular subject = 'was.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Chef Amara Sy's renown as one of the boldest voices in West African _____ cemented by a string of acclaimed tasting menus in Dakar and Lyon, has at times eclipsed her scholarship on the history of Senegalese home cooking.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: cuisine,
- B: cuisine was
- C: cuisine had been
- D: cuisine, was

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the main clause is 'Chef Amara Sy's renown...has...eclipsed her scholarship.' The phrase 'cemented by...Lyon' is a participial modifier set off by commas. Inserting 'was' or 'had been' would create a second main verb, breaking the sentence's structure. Only a comma after 'cuisine' keeps the modifier non-finite.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Now viewed as a conceptual ancestor of programmable textile machines, weaver Ines Halloran's 1911 workbook paired each pattern with a private shorthand. Though her prototype loom had limited output, the notation symbols sketched in the workbook--including a glyph that signaled an automatic color reversal--_____ a strikingly early vision of stored instructions.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has constituted

B: constituting

C: constitutes

D: constitute

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: ignore the dash parenthetical ('including...reversal'). The subject is 'the notation symbols' (plural). Only 'constitute' is plural present tense. 'Constitutes' is singular. 'Constituting' is a participle (fragment). 'Has constituted' is singular perfect.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Critics long read *Salt Meridian* (1968) and *The Ninth Tide* (1971) as unrelated memoirs. However, the parallels between the _____ childhoods--both narrators recount summers spent aboard their grandmothers' fishing trawlers--suggest that the two books form a deliberate literary conversation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: memoir's narrator's

B: memoirs' narrators'

C: memoirs' narrators

D: memoir's narrators'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: two memoirs (plural possessive = memoirs') each have narrators (plural possessive = narrators') whose childhoods are discussed. Both nouns need possessive forms: memoirs' narrators'. 'Memoirs' narrators' (C) drops the second possessive. 'Memoir's' (A, D) wrongly makes 'memoir' singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: On March 3, 1911, the survey ship Petrel Star departed Ushuaia, Argentina, commencing Voyage _____ nine weeks and four days, the crossing ended when the ship reached Fremantle, Australia, with its hull sheathed in ice scars.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: K-17. Lasting

B: K-17, lasting

C: K-17 lasting

D: K-17, it lasted

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'lasting nine weeks' must attach to Voyage K-17 as a participial phrase, not a new clause. 'K-17, lasting' correctly uses a comma + participle. 'K-17, it lasted' creates a comma splice (two independent clauses with a comma). 'K-17. Lasting' makes a fragment. 'K-17 lasting' omits the needed comma.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The murals of Valparaiso, Chile, may encode the city's economic geography. In a 2024 study, researchers examining connections between the neighborhood in which a mural was painted and _____ imagery analyzed more than 900 murals across the city. Murals in port-adjacent districts, they found, favored maritime motifs at triple the rate of hillside murals.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: they're

B: their

C: it's

D: its

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: the antecedent is 'a mural' (singular). A singular noun takes 'its' (possessive). 'Their' is tempting because '900 murals' appears later, but the sentence discusses 'a mural' individually. 'It's' = 'it is,' and 'they're' = 'they are'--both contractions, not possessives.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Working with village cooperatives between 2015 and 2022, engineer Kofi Danquah, organizer Efua Mensimah, and agronomist Lena Boateng installed microgrid training hubs as part of an effort to expand access to solar _____ but also across the wider Sahel.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: power--not only in Ghana--

B: power not only in Ghana,

C: power, not only in Ghana,

D: power--not only in Ghana

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'not only in Ghana' is a parenthetical interruption inside the phrase 'expand access to solar power...but also across the wider Sahel.' Dashes must appear in PAIRS to set off the interruption. Option D has only an opening dash with no closing dash. Commas in B and C disrupt the 'not only...but also' correlative structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Poet Deja Marchetti's 2018 collection *Saltglass* gathers forty-one poems written across a decade of coastal residencies. Marchetti's poem _____ appears midway through the collection and is often cited as its most formally daring piece, its lines splitting into twin columns that can be read in either order.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: , "Gullwing,"

B: "Gullwing,"

C: "Gullwing"

D: , "Gullwing"

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Marchetti wrote forty-one poems, so naming one specific poem is essential (restrictive) information. Essential appositives take NO commas. "Gullwing" (C) correctly omits commas. Commas before or after the title would imply she wrote only one poem, which contradicts the passage.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Weighing nearly a ton and coated in centuries of corrosion, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: the researchers struggled for two days to move the bronze temple bell.
- B: moving the bronze temple bell challenged the researchers for two days.
- C: the researchers' two-day effort to move the bronze temple bell nearly failed.
- D: the bronze temple bell resisted the researchers' efforts to move it for two days.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Weighing nearly a ton and coated in corrosion' describes a heavy, corroded OBJECT. The main clause's subject must be that object. Only D starts with 'the bronze temple bell.' The others start with 'researchers,' 'moving,' or 'effort'--none of which weigh a ton.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In her 2020 analysis of the fictional port city of Anverre, economist Solveig Ridder attributes the district's recovery not to a single sweeping policy but _____ a series of small administrative reforms enacted quietly over fifteen years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: for

B: with

C: to

D: by

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the idiom 'attributes X not to A but to B' requires parallel prepositions. 'Not to...but to' is the correct pair. 'For,' 'with,' and 'by' break the parallel structure and the idiomatic usage of 'attribute...to.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Unlike most nocturnal pollinators, yucca moths do not sip _____ they visit the flowers solely to deposit eggs and, in the process, transfer pollen between blossoms.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: nectar;

B: nectar,

C: nectar, they

D: nectar

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses ('moths do not sip nectar' and 'they visit...'). A semicolon joins them without a conjunction. A comma alone (B) or 'nectar, they' (C) creates a splice. No punctuation (D) creates a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Assembled over forty years by horticulturist Beata Lindqvist, the collection of vintage seed catalogs _____ now available online through the Millbrae Botanical Library.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: is

C: were

D: are

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: strip the opening participial phrase and the prepositional phrase 'of vintage seed catalogs.' The subject is 'collection' (singular). 'Now' signals present tense. Only 'is' is singular + present. 'Are' and 'have been' are plural. 'Were' is past tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: After a three-year structural retrofit, the Calverton Museum of Industry _____ its east wing to visitors next year with an exhibition on early refrigeration.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: reopened
- B: had reopened
- C: was reopening
- D: will reopen

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'next year' is a future time signal. Only 'will reopen' is future tense. 'Reopened' and 'had reopened' are past. 'Was reopening' is past progressive. Match the verb to the time signal.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Farmers in the fictional Drava Valley long consulted almanac writer Tobiah Krenz, who was renowned for _____ damaging hailstorms several days in advance by tracking subtle shifts in cloud color.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: predicts
- B: predicted
- C: predicting
- D: to predict

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: a preposition ('for') must be followed by a gerund (-ing form), not a finite verb or infinitive. 'Predicting' is the gerund. 'Predicts' and 'predicted' are finite verbs. 'To predict' is an infinitive--wrong after 'for.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The switchback trail up Mount Ferrow was cut entirely by hand in the 1930s by local volunteers, _____ worked in rotating crews of ten during the region's brief dry season.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whom

B: which

C: whose

D: who

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun refers to 'volunteers' (people) and serves as the SUBJECT of 'worked.' 'Who' is the subject form for people. 'Whom' is the object form. 'Which' is for things. 'Whose' is possessive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Founded in 1921, the Larkspur Symphony performs in a converted rail depot whose acoustics musicians praise. The _____ rehearsal schedule, posted each August, is built around the depot's freight-era heating system, which warms the hall only by midmorning.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: orchestras
- B: orchestras'
- C: orchestra's
- D: orchestra

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: one orchestra possesses the schedule. Singular possessive = apostrophe + s: 'orchestra's.' 'Orchestras' is a plural noun with no possession. 'Orchestras'' is plural possessive (multiple orchestras). 'Orchestra' alone is not possessive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Although the Camarra Reef lies entirely within a patrolled marine _____ poaching of ornamental fish persists along its western edge, where patrol boats cannot navigate the shallow coral heads.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: reserve;

B: reserve.

C: reserve,

D: reserve

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Although...reserve' is a subordinate clause. A comma separates it from the main clause ('poaching...persists'). A semicolon wrongly treats the 'Although' clause as independent. A period creates a fragment. No punctuation creates a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Despite two decades of excavation at the hillfort site, there _____ several unresolved questions about how its builders transported timber across the surrounding bogland.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: remain

B: remains

C: is

D: was

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: in 'there _____ X' constructions, the verb agrees with what follows 'there.' The true subject is 'several...questions' (plural + present). Only 'remain' is plural present. 'Remains' and 'is' are singular. 'Was' is singular past.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In 1889, engineer Philomena Darrow designed a counterweighted canal lock for the fictional Brindle Cut and _____ a patent that described the mechanism in fourteen hand-linked diagrams.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: files

B: filed

C: will file

D: is filing

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the compound predicate is 'designed...and _____. ' Both verbs share the same past-tense time frame ('In 1889'). 'Filed' matches 'designed' in simple past. The other options are present, future, or present progressive--all wrong for 1889.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Excavations at the lakeside settlement of Vodran yielded three classes of weaving _____ spindle whorls, clay loom weights, and finely toothed loom combs carved from antler.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: equipment,
- B: equipment;
- C: equipment
- D: equipment:

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: a list follows a complete independent clause. A colon correctly introduces a list after a full clause. A comma would make the list an unclear continuation. A semicolon is for joining clauses, not introducing lists. No punctuation runs the clause into the list.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 41

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The pigment, a stable synthetic ultramarine first produced commercially in _____ transformed fresco restoration by allowing conservators to match medieval blues without mining lapis lazuli.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1928;

B: 1928--

C: 1928.

D: 1928,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the phrase 'a stable synthetic ultramarine first produced commercially in 1928' is a nonessential appositive set off by commas or dashes. The opening comma before 'a stable' must be matched. A dash closes the aside and signals the main clause resumes. A semicolon or period would fragment the sentence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Attribution of the studio's surviving works remains contested: neither the preparatory sketches nor the finished canvas _____ signed, and the workshop's ledgers list only materials, never artists.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: are

C: was

D: were

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: with 'neither...nor,' the verb agrees with the CLOSER subject--'the finished canvas' (singular). 'Was' is singular past. 'Were' (plural), 'are' (plural present), and 'have been' (plural perfect) all wrongly agree with 'sketches.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 43

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Since opening in 2018, the Ostrava Ice Core Facility _____ more than 400 samples for laboratories on four continents, maintaining an unbroken storage temperature of -36 degrees C throughout.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: processed
- B: processes
- C: had processed
- D: has processed

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Since' + a past time point requires present perfect to show an action spanning past to present. 'Has processed' is correct (singular subject 'Facility'). 'Processed' (simple past) drops the ongoing connection. 'Had processed' (past perfect) is for an action completed before another past event.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 44

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The archive's oldest chart, drawn on vellum and _____ in 1502 by two Genoese hands, shows a coastline annotated in a mixture of Latin and Ligurian dialect.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: annotated

B: annotating

C: annotates

D: to annotate

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the pair is 'drawn on vellum and _____ in 1502'--two parallel past participles modifying 'chart.' 'Annotated' matches 'drawn.' 'Annotating' (present participle), 'annotates' (finite verb), and 'to annotate' (infinitive) all break the parallel structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: After eleven weeks of public hearings on the proposed transit corridor, the zoning committee announced _____ unanimous decision at a session that lasted barely four minutes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: its

B: their

C: it's

D: whose

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the zoning committee' is a singular collective noun in American English. It takes 'its' (singular possessive). 'Their' would be plural. 'It's' = 'it is' (contraction). 'Whose' is for relative clauses, not direct possession here.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Each December, the _____ choir at the Fenwick Music School performs carols arranged by its own singers, all of them between the ages of eight and twelve.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: childrens'

B: childrens

C: children

D: children's

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'children' is an irregular plural (it does not end in s). To make an irregular plural possessive, add apostrophe + s: 'children's.' 'Childrens'' and 'childrens' add a false s. 'Children' without the apostrophe is not possessive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 47

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: After analyzing two decades of tide-gauge records from the harbor, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: the seawall's design was revised by the port authority's engineers to add a curved deflector lip.

B: the port authority's engineers revised the seawall's design to add a curved deflector lip.

C: revisions adding a curved deflector lip were made to the seawall's design.

D: the seawall's design underwent revision to add a curved deflector lip.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'After analyzing...' needs a human agent as the subject. Only B starts with 'the port authority's engineers'--people who can analyze data. A starts with 'the seawall's design,' C with 'revisions,' D with 'the seawall's design'--none can 'analyze.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The independent audit credited the clinic network with lowering per-visit costs, expanding rural coverage, and _____ average wait times by nearly a third over five years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: reduced

B: to reduce

C: reducing

D: it reduced

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the list structure is 'lowering...expanding...and _____. All items must be gerunds to maintain parallel form. 'Reducing' matches. 'Reduced' (past participle), 'to reduce' (infinitive), and 'it reduced' (new clause) all break the pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Harrow Bend gristmill ceased commercial operation in _____ its oak waterwheel still turns every Saturday for demonstrations run by a volunteer millwright society.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1962; but

B: 1962 but

C: 1962,

D: 1962, but

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses joined by 'but' need a comma before the conjunction: '1962, but.' A semicolon + 'but' is redundant. 'But' without a comma is wrong when joining two full independent clauses. A comma without a conjunction creates a splice.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 50

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The fisheries accord of 1948, _____ quota provisions quietly expired in 1970, is still cited in maritime law courses as a model of enforceable treaty language.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whose

B: who's

C: which

D: that

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun must show possession--the accord's provisions. 'Whose' is the possessive relative pronoun. 'Who's' = 'who is.' 'Which' and 'that' are non-possessive and would need a restructured clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 51

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The shipwreck's cargo hold had collapsed, yet the silt preserved its contents in place: among the recovered items _____ a bronze astrolabe and two waterlogged merchant ledgers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has been

B: is

C: were

D: was

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: inverted structure--the true subject follows the verb. 'A bronze astrolabe AND two waterlogged merchant ledgers' is a compound subject (plural). Past context demands past tense. Only 'were' is plural past. 'Was' is singular. 'Is' and 'has been' are singular present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 52

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In the greenhouse trials, the results were _____ every seedling grown under the spectrally filtered light outperformed its unfiltered control in both root mass and leaf area.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: unambiguous,

B: unambiguous:

C: unambiguous

D: unambiguous and

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the second clause explains/elaborates on 'unambiguous'--this is a classic colon situation. A comma creates a splice between two ICs. No punctuation creates a run-on. 'And' would need a comma before it and doesn't signal the explanatory relationship.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 53

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: To track how tidewater ice responds to warming fjord currents, glaciologist Maren Ostvik's team fixed time-lapse cameras above the fictional Skalvir Fjord. The glacier _____ the fjord's northern arm, which had retreated behind a submerged rock sill during the 1990s, calved bergs large enough to close the shipping lane for days.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: occupied

B: occupying

C: occupies

D: was occupying

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'The glacier occupying the fjord's northern arm...calved bergs.'

'Occupying' is a present participle forming a reduced relative clause ('that occupied').

'Occupied' or 'was occupying' would create two competing finite verbs ('occupied/was occupying...calved') with no conjunction. 'Occupies' is present tense in a past narrative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 54

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Aerospace designers prize the ceramic composite silvorine because it is one of the few structural materials that _____ tensile strength above 1,400 degrees C, a threshold at which most alloys begin to slump.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has retained

B: is retaining

C: retain

D: retains

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: in 'one of the few materials that _____,' 'that' refers to 'materials' (plural), not 'one.' The verb must be plural: 'retain.' 'Retains' wrongly agrees with 'one.' 'Has retained' is singular. 'Is retaining' is singular progressive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 55

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The restoration of the Quillon Street pumping station finally began in March, after three _____ delay caused by disputes over which era of the building's machinery deserved preservation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: years'

B: years

C: year's

D: years's

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'three years' is plural, and the delay belongs to those years. Plural possessive of a regular noun ending in s = add apostrophe after the s: 'years'.' 'Year's' is singular possessive (one year). 'Years' has no possession. 'Years's' is not a standard form.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 56

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Investigators concluded that the 1974 flood's damage to the county archive was avoidable: had the earthen levee been maintained to its original specifications, the water _____ the building's ground-floor stacks at all.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: will not have reached

B: had not reached

C: would not reach

D: would not have reached

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: past counterfactual ('had the levee been maintained') requires 'would + have + past participle' in the result clause. 'Would not have reached' is correct. 'Would not reach' is a present counterfactual. 'Had not reached' repeats the condition form. 'Will not have reached' is future perfect.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 57

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Between 1898 and 1911, master enameler Sachiko Torii trained fourteen apprentices, several of _____ later opened studios of their own in Kanazawa and helped establish the region's reputation for translucent cloisonne.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whom

B: which

C: who

D: them

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'of' is a preposition, so the pronoun must be in objective case: 'whom.' 'Who' is nominative (subject form). 'Which' is for things, not people. 'Them' would create a comma splice rather than a relative clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 58

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Novelist Hetty Marlowe completed a single work of long fiction before abandoning literature for courtroom journalism. Marlowe's only novel, _____ was published posthumously in 1953 from a typescript her sister had preserved in a bank vault.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Cinder Road

B: Cinder Road;

C: Cinder Road:

D: Cinder Road,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Marlowe wrote only ONE novel, so the title is nonessential (we already know which novel). Nonessential appositives are set off by commas: 'Marlowe's only novel, Cinder Road, was...' The opening comma is already in the prompt, so the closing comma must follow the title.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 59

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Media historian Priya Venkatesan argues that a familiar pattern is repeating: just as the printing press gradually standardized English spelling across regions, _____ streaming platforms are now standardizing pronunciation across dialects.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: and

B: so

C: therefore

D: likewise

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'just as...so' is a correlative pair showing parallel comparison. 'So' is the only word that completes this fixed pattern. 'And' lacks the comparative force. 'Therefore' and 'likewise' are not part of the 'just as' idiom.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 60

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Conservators assessing the monastery's water-damaged library reported a sobering figure: nearly 40 percent of the recovered manuscripts _____ ink migration severe enough to obscure at least one full page of text.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: has shown
- B: is showing
- C: show
- D: shows

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'percent of [plural noun]' takes a plural verb. The subject is '40 percent of the recovered manuscripts'--since 'manuscripts' is plural, the verb must be plural. 'Show' is the only plural option. 'Shows,' 'has shown,' and 'is showing' are all singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 61

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The greenhouse's automated vents open whenever the interior temperature climbs above a set _____ they close again once the air has cooled.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: threshold, they

B: threshold they

C: threshold, and

D: threshold and

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction ('and') need a comma before the conjunction. 'Threshold, and' is correct. A comma without a conjunction (A) creates a splice. No punctuation at all (B, D) creates a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 62

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The archive of ferry timetables, gathered by a retired harbormaster over three decades, _____ a rare picture of how coastal travel shifted after the bridge opened.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: offers

B: offer

C: have offered

D: are offering

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: strip the appositive ('gathered...decades'). The subject is 'archive' (singular). Present tense is needed for a current state. 'Offers' is the only singular present option. 'Offer,' 'have offered,' and 'are offering' are all plural forms.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 63

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Nardo Glass Cooperative closed its furnaces in 1987, but a group of former apprentices _____ the workshop in 2009 and now trains a new generation of glassblowers there.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: reopens

B: will reopen

C: is reopening

D: reopened

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'in 2009' is a completed past action--simple past is required. 'Reopened' matches. 'Reopens' is present. 'Will reopen' is future. 'Is reopening' is present progressive. The time marker determines the tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 64

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Sculptor Ravi Kulkarni is known for _____ discarded farm tools into towering figures that seem to stride across the fields where the metal was once used.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: transforms
- B: transforming
- C: transformed
- D: to transform

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'known for' is followed by a gerund (-ing form). 'Transforming' is correct. 'Transforms' and 'transformed' are finite verbs--wrong after a preposition. 'To transform' is an infinitive, wrong after 'for.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 65

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Each of the five apprentice bakers at the Vellsholm bakery _____ responsible for a single stage of the morning's production, from mixing to final glazing.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: are

B: is

C: were

D: have been

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Each' is always singular regardless of the prepositional phrase ('of the five bakers'). Present tense is indicated by the habitual context. 'Is' is correct. 'Are,' 'were,' and 'have been' are plural or wrong tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 66

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Because the manuscript's binding had grown too fragile to open, conservators photographed each page through a specially built cradle _____ held the covers at a shallow angle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: who
- B: whom
- C: what
- D: that

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: the antecedent is 'cradle' (a thing). 'That' is the relative pronoun for things in restrictive clauses. 'Who' and 'whom' are for people only. 'What' does not function as a relative pronoun modifying a specific noun.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 67

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The lighthouse keeper's logbooks, water-stained but legible, reveal a startling detail: for eleven consecutive winters, the beam _____ dimmed for exactly one hour each night.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: was

B: were

C: are

D: have been

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is 'the beam' (singular). The time frame is past ('eleven consecutive winters'). 'Was' is singular past. 'Were' is plural. 'Are' and 'have been' are present tense. Do not confuse 'logbooks' (earlier subject) with 'beam.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 68

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: When did the practice of tuning instruments to a shared reference pitch become _____ answer involves a series of international conferences held over the nineteenth century.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: standard, the

B: standard the

C: standard? The

D: standard. The

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'When did...become standard' is a question--it must end with a question mark. 'The answer' begins a new declarative sentence (capital T). A comma (A) creates a splice. No punctuation (B) is a run-on. A period (D) ignores the interrogative structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 69

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The city's oldest tram line, built in 1904 and restored in _____ carries commuters along the same riverfront route it served more than a century ago.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 2011;

B: 2011:

C: 2011

D: 2011,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'built in 1904 and restored in 2011' is a nonessential phrase set off by commas. The opening comma appears before 'built,' so a matching comma must close the phrase after '2011.' A semicolon, colon, or no punctuation would fail to properly close the aside.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 70

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The report identified three obstacles to the reforestation _____ compacted soil, an absence of native seed stock, and browsing pressure from an overpopulation of deer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: project;

B: project,

C: project:

D: project

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'three obstacles' signals a list is coming. A colon after a complete independent clause introduces that list. A semicolon joins clauses, not lists. A comma would blur where the clause ends and the list begins. No punctuation is a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 71

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The coin, a silver denarius struck during a brief and turbulent _____ was unearthed beneath a former marketplace and has helped historians date the site's abandonment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: reign,

B: reign;

C: reign:

D: reign

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'a silver denarius struck during a brief and turbulent reign' is a nonessential appositive. The opening comma before 'a silver' demands a closing comma after 'reign.' A semicolon, colon, or no punctuation fails to close the parenthetical.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 72

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Neither the field notebooks nor the annotated map _____ any indication of where the expedition's fourth camp had been established.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have provided

B: provides

C: are providing

D: provide

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'neither...nor' means the verb agrees with the nearer subject. 'The annotated map' (singular) is closer to the verb. 'Provides' is singular present. 'Provide' is plural. 'Have provided' and 'are providing' are plural forms. Present tense fits the current state of evidence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 73

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Since the observatory installed its adaptive-optics system in 2015, the number of confirmed exoplanet detections credited to the facility _____ more than tripled.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has

B: have

C: are

D: were

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the number of' is always singular (it refers to the number itself, not the items). 'Has' is singular. Compare with 'a number of,' which IS plural. 'Have,' 'are,' and 'were' are plural--wrong for 'the number.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 74

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The tapestry, woven in the fifteenth century and _____ in the nineteenth, depicts a hunting scene whose colors have faded unevenly across its enormous width.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: repairing

B: repaired

C: repairs

D: to repair

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'woven...and _____' requires parallel past participles. 'Repaired' matches 'woven.' 'Repairing' is present participle. 'Repairs' is a finite verb. 'To repair' is an infinitive. All three break the parallel structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 75

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: After the town council spent two years debating the fate of the derelict cannery, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: a decision to convert it into a public market was finally reached by the members.

B: converting it into a public market was the decision finally reached.

C: the derelict cannery's conversion into a public market was finally decided.

D: the members finally reached a decision to convert it into a public market.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: while this opener names 'the town council' as agent, the main clause should logically continue with a human subject performing an action. D starts with 'the members'--the people who debated. The other options start with 'a decision,' 'converting,' or 'the cannery's conversion'--inanimate nouns that obscure the actor.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 76

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The grant will allow the museum to digitize its photographic negatives, catalog its uncataloged sculpture, and _____ climate control to its most vulnerable storage rooms.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: extending

B: extended

C: extend

D: extends

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'to digitize, catalog, and _____' requires parallel bare infinitives (the 'to' carries over). 'Extend' matches. 'Extending' (gerund), 'extended' (past), and 'extends' (finite present) all break the pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 77

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The observatory suspended public tours in _____ its aging dome mechanism had begun to jam, and repairs required the removal of scaffolding that blocked the visitor gallery.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 2019 for

B: 2019; for,

C: 2019, for

D: 2019: for

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'for' here is a coordinating conjunction meaning 'because.' Before a coordinating conjunction joining two ICs, use a comma. '2019, for' is correct. No punctuation before 'for' (A) makes a run-on. A semicolon before 'for' (B) is redundant. A colon (D) doesn't fit the causal relationship.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 78

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The composer Livia Sernau, _____ early symphonies were dismissed as derivative, is now credited with pioneering the microtonal techniques that defined the following decade.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whose

B: who's

C: who

D: which

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun must show that the symphonies belong to the composer. 'Whose' is the possessive relative pronoun. 'Who's' = 'who is.' 'Who' (subject form) and 'which' (for things) do not show possession.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 79

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Preserved in the anaerobic mud of the bog for two millennia, the leather satchel and its contents _____ remarkably intact when a peat cutter uncovered them in 1954.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: was

B: were

C: is

D: has been

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the leather satchel AND its contents' is a compound subject (plural). Past tense is needed for '1954.' 'Were' is plural past. 'Was' is singular. 'Is' and 'has been' are singular present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 80

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The economist attributed the region's resilience not to a windfall of resources but _____ a diversified base of small manufacturers that could absorb shocks in any single sector.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: from

B: with

C: by

D: to

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'attributed X not to A but to B' requires matching prepositions. 'Not to...but to' is the parallel pair. 'From,' 'with,' and 'by' break the idiom and the parallel structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 81

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The excavation records were finally _____ every artifact had been logged with a photograph, a grid coordinate, and a stratigraphic layer number, allowing later researchers to reconstruct the dig with confidence.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: complete:

B: complete,

C: complete

D: complete and

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the second clause elaborates on what 'complete' means in context. A colon after an independent clause introduces that elaboration. A comma creates a splice. No punctuation is a run-on. 'And' changes the logical relationship from elaboration to addition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 82

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: To measure how urban canopy loss affects summer heat, climatologist Idris Fanaka's team mounted sensors along a transect of city blocks. The neighborhood _____ the transect's eastern end, which had lost nearly half its street trees to a decade of construction, recorded nighttime temperatures four degrees higher than the leafy blocks to the west.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: anchored

B: anchors

C: had anchored

D: anchoring

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'The neighborhood anchoring the transect's eastern end...recorded temperatures.' 'Anchoring' is a present participle forming a reduced relative clause. 'Anchored' or 'had anchored' would create two competing main verbs ('anchored...recorded') with no conjunction. 'Anchors' is present tense in a past narrative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 83

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Metallurgists value the alloy dravantium because it is one of the few casting materials that _____ almost no shrinkage as it cools, a property prized for producing precise, gap-free molds.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has exhibited

B: is exhibiting

C: exhibit

D: exhibits

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'one of the few materials that _____' -- 'that' refers to 'materials' (plural). The verb must be plural: 'exhibit.' 'Exhibits' wrongly agrees with 'one.' 'Has exhibited' and 'is exhibiting' are singular. This is one of the most common DSAT traps.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 84

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The renovation of the concert hall was delayed by nearly four _____ dispute over whether the original horsehair plaster, prized for its acoustics, could be legally replaced with a modern equivalent.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: months

B: months'

C: month's

D: months's

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'four months' is plural, and the dispute 'belongs to' that time period. Plural possessive for a regular noun = apostrophe after the s: 'months'.' 'Month's' is singular possessive. 'Months' without apostrophe lacks possession. 'Months's' is not standard English.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 85

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Archivists concluded that the ledger's water damage had been preventable: had the basement's sump pump been serviced on schedule, the floodwater _____ the shelving where the oldest volumes were stored.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: will never have reached

B: had never reached

C: would never reach

D: would never have reached

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: past counterfactual (unreal condition about the past) requires 'would + have + past participle.' The condition ('had...been serviced') is past perfect, so the result must be 'would never have reached.' 'Would never reach' is present counterfactual. 'Had never reached' repeats the condition structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 86

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Over a fourteen-year correspondence, botanist Cornelia Ashby exchanged specimens with dozens of collectors, many of _____ she never met in person yet regarded as her closest scientific colleagues.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whom

B: who

C: which

D: them

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'of' is a preposition; the pronoun after it must be objective case. 'Whom' is the objective form for people. 'Who' is nominative. 'Which' is for things. 'Them' would create a comma splice instead of a relative clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 87

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Playwright Delano Sarr completed only one work for the stage before turning to film criticism. Sarr's sole play, _____ was revived in 1998 by a company determined to rescue it from obscurity, and the production ran for two sold-out seasons.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: The Ferryman's Wager
- B: The Ferryman's Wager,
- C: The Ferryman's Wager;
- D: The Ferryman's Wager:

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sarr wrote only ONE play, so the title is nonessential (already identified by 'sole play'). Nonessential appositives are set off by commas. The opening comma is in the prompt; the closing comma must follow the title. A semicolon or colon would break the appositive structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 88

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Linguist Marisol Ekwe contends that a familiar dynamic is recurring: just as radio once accelerated the spread of standardized broadcast accents, _____ short-form video is now accelerating the spread of a handful of dominant speech patterns among young speakers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: and

B: thus

C: so

D: similarly

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'just as...so' is a fixed correlative pair for parallel comparison. Only 'so' completes it. 'And,' 'thus,' and 'similarly' are not part of this idiom.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 89

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: A survey of the flooded riverside district produced a grim statistic: nearly a third of the surveyed _____ structural damage severe enough to require demolition rather than repair.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: buildings has sustained
- B: building had sustained
- C: buildings had sustained
- D: buildings, having sustained

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'a third of the surveyed buildings' -- 'buildings' is plural, so the verb is plural: 'had sustained.' Past perfect fits the time frame (damage preceded the survey). 'Has sustained' is singular. 'Building' (singular) doesn't match 'a third of.' 'Having sustained' creates a fragment.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 90

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The essayist's late work is often misread as a retreat into nostalgia; _____ close attention to its imagery reveals a sustained, unsentimental argument about the costs of technological progress.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: therefore,
- B: however,
- C: likewise,
- D: for example,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the second clause contradicts the first (not a retreat, but an argument). Only 'however' signals contrast. 'Therefore' signals cause-effect. 'Likewise' signals similarity. 'For example' signals illustration. Match the transition to the logical relationship.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 91

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Freight barges no longer use the Brindle _____ now draws kayakers, anglers, and a summer procession of tour boats narrating its towpath history.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Canal, which

B: Canal. Which

C: Canal; which

D: Canal which

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'which now draws...' is a nonessential relative clause modifying 'Canal.' It must be attached with a comma: 'Canal, which.' A period (B) makes 'Which now draws...' a fragment. A semicolon (C) cannot introduce a relative clause. No punctuation (D) treats it as restrictive but drops the required comma for a nonessential clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 92

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The dosage instructions on the medication's outer label _____ deliberately printed in three languages and in a typeface tested for readability in low light.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: was

B: has been

C: is

D: are

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is 'instructions' (plural). Present tense matches the general description. 'Are' is plural present. 'Was,' 'has been,' and 'is' are all singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 93

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: During the 1930s, the coastal radio station at Pellam Head _____ nightly forecasts that fishing crews across the strait planned their departures around.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: broadcast

B: broadcasts

C: will broadcast

D: is broadcasting

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'During the 1930s' signals past tense. 'Broadcast' is both present and past tense (irregular verb). In past context, 'broadcast' is correct. 'Broadcasts' is present (third-person). 'Will broadcast' is future. 'Is broadcasting' is present progressive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 94

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: According to the trial protocol, the vaccine must _____ stored below -60 degrees C from the moment of manufacture until minutes before injection.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: been

B: being

C: is

D: be

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: after a modal verb ('must'), the base form follows: 'must be.' The passive is 'must be stored.' 'Been' needs 'have' before it. 'Being' creates a progressive that doesn't fit the requirement. 'Is' cannot follow a modal directly.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 95

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Working from opposite ends of the wall, the twin muralists finished _____ hundred-meter painting in nineteen days, meeting precisely at the harbor gate.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: there

B: they're

C: their

D: theirs

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the muralists possess the painting--possessive pronoun needed. 'Their' is the possessive. 'There' is an adverb of place. 'They're' = 'they are.' 'Theirs' is a standalone possessive pronoun, not an adjective before a noun.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 96

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Vinyl record sales in the fictional Averil Isles peaked in the _____ before cassette players installed in fishing boats reshaped how islanders bought music.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1970's

B: 1970s

C: 1970s'

D: 1970

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: plural decades do not need an apostrophe: '1970s.' The apostrophe in '1970's' implies possession or contraction--neither applies. '1970s'' is a possessive plural form. '1970' is just a single year, not a decade.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 97

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: By the end of the nineteenth _____ the practice of paying lighthouse keepers partly in lamp oil had vanished from every station on the coast.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: century;

B: century,

C: century.

D: century

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'By the end of the nineteenth century' is an introductory prepositional phrase. A comma follows it before the main clause. A semicolon (A) wrongly treats the phrase as an independent clause. A period (C) creates a fragment. No punctuation (D) is a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 98

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Among the volunteers who restored the tide mill, there _____ little doubt that the machinery's survival owed everything to the thick coat of lanolin applied before the war.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: were

C: was

D: are

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'there _____ little doubt' -- the true subject is 'doubt' (singular, uncountable). 'Was' is singular past. 'Were' is plural. 'Are' and 'have been' are plural present. 'Little doubt' is singular despite 'volunteers' appearing earlier.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 99

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Marlowe Street choir has _____ the same processional anthem on the first Sunday of spring for nearly seventy years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: sang

B: sing

C: singing

D: sung

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'has _____' requires a past participle. The irregular forms of 'sing' are sing/sang/sung. 'Sung' is the past participle. 'Sang' is simple past (no 'has'). 'Sing' is base form. 'Singing' is present participle.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 100

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The footbridge passed its annual load _____ engineers flagged corrosion in two anchor plates and scheduled their replacement for the autumn.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: inspection; however,
- B: inspection, however,
- C: inspection however
- D: inspection:

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'however' is a conjunctive adverb joining two independent clauses. It needs a semicolon before it and a comma after it. A comma before 'however' (B) creates a splice. No punctuation (C) is a run-on. A colon (D) doesn't signal contrast.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 101

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The documentary's director, as well as its two producers, _____ attending the festival screening to answer questions about the film's decade-long production.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been

B: were

C: are

D: is

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'as well as' does NOT create a compound subject. It is parenthetical, like 'along with.' The true subject is 'director' (singular). 'Is' is correct. 'Are,' 'were,' and 'have been' are plural--they wrongly treat 'producers' as part of the subject.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 102

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Rosa Calvette's 1962 novel *The Longest Ferry* ends where it began: in the final chapter, the narrator _____ to the island of her childhood and finds the ferry schedule unchanged after thirty years.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: returns

B: returned

C: will return

D: had returned

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: when describing events within a work of literature, use literary present tense. 'Returns' matches 'ends' and 'finds'--all present. 'Returned,' 'will return,' and 'had returned' break the literary present convention.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 103

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Entomologist Priya Raghunathan spent the summer of 2021 _____ beetle specimens from a single fallen oak, ultimately identifying 240 species living within one trunk.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: catalog

B: cataloging

C: to catalog

D: cataloged

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'spent [time] + gerund' is the correct pattern. 'Spent the summer cataloging' is idiomatic. 'Catalog' (base form), 'to catalog' (infinitive), and 'cataloged' (past) do not follow 'spent [time].'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 104

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The reading-room rules are strict: if one wishes to consult the medieval charters, _____ must register a week in advance and handle the documents only with the tools provided.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: you

B: they

C: one

D: we

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: pronoun consistency--'one' was established in the first clause. Switching to 'you,' 'they,' or 'we' mid-sentence creates an inconsistent shift. 'One...one' maintains formal consistency throughout.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 105

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Every autumn, the Rivera family hosts the entire block at a long table set up in the alley; neighbors mark their calendars months ahead for the _____ harvest dinner.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Rivera's

B: Riveras

C: Riveras'

D: Riveras's

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the dinner belongs to the Rivera FAMILY (multiple people). Pluralize the surname first (Riveras), then add the possessive apostrophe: Riveras'. 'Rivera's' is singular possessive (one person). 'Riveras' is plural but not possessive. 'Riveras's' is not standard.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 106

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Hoping to attract migrating warblers to the schoolyard, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: native berry shrubs were planted along the fence line by the volunteers.

B: the volunteers planted native berry shrubs along the fence line.

C: the planting of native berry shrubs along the fence line began in March.

D: native berry shrubs replaced the ornamental hedge along the fence line.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Hoping to attract' must modify a human agent. Only B starts with 'the volunteers'--people who can hope. A starts with 'shrubs,' C with 'the planting,' D with 'shrubs'--none can hope.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 107

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Facing a repair estimate larger than its annual budget, the parish council voted to either restore the pipe organ in place or _____ it to a museum with the resources to maintain it.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: donate

B: donating

C: donated

D: to donate

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'to either restore...or _____' -- the 'to' is shared. The structure is 'to either [verb] or [verb].' 'Donate' matches 'restore' as a bare infinitive. 'Donating' (gerund), 'donated' (past), and 'to donate' (repeating 'to') break the pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 108

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: At the Vessing pottery workshop, apprentices learned one rule before any _____ the kiln door stays shut until the count of two hundred, no matter what sounds come from inside.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: other,

B: other and

C: other

D: other:

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'one rule' is followed by the rule itself--a colon introduces that elaboration. A comma (A) creates a splice. 'And' (B) doesn't signal an introduction. No punctuation (C) is a run-on. The colon says: 'here is the rule.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 109

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Everyone in the three villages along the Corvel River _____ invited to the bridge's reopening, and nearly two thousand people crossed it on foot that first morning.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: was

B: were

C: are

D: have been

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'everyone' is always singular regardless of the prepositional phrase ('in the three villages'). Past tense matches the narrative. 'Was' is singular past. 'Were' is plural. 'Are' and 'have been' are present tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 110

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In 1957, the new dam created a reservoir _____ submerged the old post road, forcing mail carriers onto a mountain route that added a day to every delivery.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: whom

B: to which

C: , it

D: that

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun modifies 'reservoir' (a thing) and is the SUBJECT of 'submerged.' 'That' is the restrictive relative pronoun for things. 'Whom' is for people in object position. ', it' creates a comma splice. 'To which' would need a different clause structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 111

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: By 1900, the fictional Corvane telegraph network _____ to forty stations, linking mining camps that had been reachable only by mule track a decade earlier.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has grown

B: grows

C: had grown

D: will have grown

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'By 1900' signals an action completed before a past reference point--past perfect ('had grown') is required. 'Has grown' is present perfect. 'Grows' is present tense. 'Will have grown' is future perfect. Match the verb to the 'by + past date' structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 112

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Delegates to the 1911 congress on port sanitation traveled from Osaka, _____ and Porto, Portugal, making it the first such gathering with representatives from three continents.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Japan, Gdansk, Poland,

B: Japan; Gdansk, Poland;

C: Japan; Gdansk; Poland;

D: Japan, Gdansk; Poland,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: when list items contain internal commas (city, country), semicolons separate the items. Pattern: 'Osaka, Japan; Gdansk, Poland; and Porto, Portugal.' Only B uses semicolons correctly between items while keeping commas within them.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 113

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The merger left the firm with two incompatible accounting systems, one inherited from each predecessor. To reconcile the two ledgers--line by line, across seventeen years of entries--_____ the auditors' first and most tedious task.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: were

B: was

C: being

D: having been

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is the infinitive phrase 'To reconcile the two ledgers' (always singular). Ignore 'ledgers,' 'entries'--they are inside the phrase. 'Was' is singular. 'Were' wrongly treats 'ledgers' as the subject. 'Being' and 'having been' create fragments.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 114

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Three rivers--the Sarn, the Vell, and the _____ converge in a braided delta below the citadel, and the city's oldest maps are essentially attempts to fix their wandering channels on paper.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Odra--

B: Odra,

C: Odra;

D: Odra:

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: the opening '--' before 'the Sarn' must be closed with a matching '--' after the last river name. Dashes work in pairs for parenthetical lists. 'Odra--' closes the pair. A comma, semicolon, or colon would leave the dash pair unmatched.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 115

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Before the telegraph reached the archipelago, each of the coastal colonies maintained _____ own signal tower, relaying storm warnings island to island with flags by day and lamps by night.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: there

B: their

C: it's

D: its

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'each' is always singular. The possessive pronoun must match: 'its.' 'Their' is plural--tempting because 'colonies' is nearby. 'It's' = 'it is.' 'There' is an adverb. The key word is 'each,' not 'colonies.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 116

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: At the close of the 1907 session, the interior minister announced that the long-postponed land census _____ the following spring, beginning with the river provinces where boundary disputes were most frequent.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: will begin
- B: begins
- C: would begin
- D: had begun

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: reported speech after a past-tense verb ('announced') shifts 'will' to 'would.' The original words were 'the census will begin,' but in reported speech: 'announced that...would begin.' 'Will begin' fails to shift. 'Begins' is present. 'Had begun' implies it already started.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 117

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Foundry records explain why the alloy fell out of use despite its durability: its melting point exceeds _____ of bronze by more than 400 degrees, demanding furnaces few workshops could afford to run.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: those

B: the one

C: it

D: that

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: comparing one singular thing to another requires the pronoun 'that.' 'Its melting point exceeds that of bronze' -- 'that' replaces 'the melting point.' 'Those' is for plural comparisons. 'The one' is awkward. 'It' is ambiguous and lacks the prepositional structure.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 118

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: At 3:14 a.m. on June 8, seismographs at the Kolvane volcano observatory registered the first pulse of a harmonic swarm, and technicians began logging Sequence _____ eleven minutes, the swarm ended as abruptly as it had begun.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: V-9, it lasted

B: V-9. Lasting

C: V-9, lasting

D: V-9 lasting

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'lasting eleven minutes' must attach as a participial phrase to the preceding clause, not start a new one. 'V-9, lasting' correctly uses a comma + participle. 'V-9, it lasted' creates a comma splice. 'V-9. Lasting' makes 'Lasting...' a fragment. 'V-9 lasting' drops the needed comma.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 119

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Though the Tessary tablets record little beyond grain tallies, the marginal symbols pressed into their edges--among them a recurring sign that scholars read as denoting an eclipse--_____ evidence of far more systematic record keeping than the tallies alone suggest.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: offer

B: offers

C: offering

D: has offered

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: strip the dash parenthetical. The subject is 'the marginal symbols' (plural). 'Offer' is plural present. 'Offers' and 'has offered' are singular. 'Offering' creates a fragment. Don't let the singular nouns inside the dashes mislead you.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 120

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Marine biologist Adaeze Ndiaye and acoustician Tomas Sorel spent eleven years recording reef soundscapes together. The findings of _____ decade-long collaboration upended assumptions about how larval fish locate coral to settle on.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: Ndiaye's and Sorel's

B: Ndiaye and Sorel's

C: Ndiaye and Sorels'

D: Ndiaye's and Sorel

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: they share ONE collaboration (joint possession). For joint possession, only the last name gets the possessive: 'Ndiaye and Sorel's.' If each had a separate collaboration, both names would need possessives ('Ndiaye's and Sorel's'). 'Sorels'' misspells the name.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 121

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Although the satellite's primary camera failed just three months into the _____ the secondary instrument captured enough data to salvage the mission's core objectives.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: mission,

B: mission.

C: mission;

D: mission

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Although...mission' is a subordinate clause; a comma separates it from the main clause. A period (B) fragments the subordinate clause. A semicolon (C) treats the 'Although' clause as independent. No punctuation (D) is a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 122

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The samples from the two deepest boreholes _____ a chemical signature consistent with volcanic ash, supporting the theory that the valley's clay layer originated from a distant eruption.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has exhibited

B: exhibit

C: is exhibiting

D: exhibits

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is 'samples' (plural). Present tense fits the current scientific finding. 'Exhibit' is plural present. 'Exhibits,' 'has exhibited,' and 'is exhibiting' are all singular forms.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 123

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Every August, the community potters of Salla Village _____ their kilns for the annual firing, a week-long event that draws buyers from across the province.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: prepared

B: will have prepared

C: prepare

D: preparing

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Every August' signals a habitual present action. 'Prepare' is simple present, matching the recurring event. 'Prepared' is past. 'Will have prepared' is future perfect. 'Preparing' is a participle that creates a fragment.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 124

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Faced with a crumbling seawall, the harbor commission hired structural engineers _____ the foundation and recommend the least disruptive repair method.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: assessing

B: assessed

C: assess

D: to assess

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'hired [someone] to [do something]' uses an infinitive of purpose. 'To assess' explains why the engineers were hired. 'Assessing' (participle), 'assessed' (past), and 'assess' (bare infinitive without 'to') do not fit the 'hired...to' pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 125

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The survey vessel towed a magnetometer, a device _____ detects buried iron by measuring disturbances in the Earth's magnetic field.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: who

B: that

C: whom

D: whose

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'device' is a thing, not a person. 'That' is the relative pronoun for things in restrictive clauses and serves as the subject of 'detects.' 'Who' and 'whom' are for people. 'Whose' is possessive--not needed here.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 126

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: After the flood receded, one _____ mudroom still contained a shelf of undamaged preserves, a small miracle that the family credited to the room's unusually tight door seal.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: family's
- B: families
- C: families'
- D: familys'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'one family' is singular. Singular possessive = apostrophe + s: 'family's.' 'Families' is plural with no possession. 'Families'' is plural possessive (multiple families). 'Familys'' is not a valid English form.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 127

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The harbor's original lighthouse was dismantled in _____ a solar-powered beacon on a steel frame now marks the channel instead.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 1978,

B: 1978

C: 1978:

D: 1978.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: two completely independent clauses with no conjunction need a period (or semicolon). 'In 1978.' ends the first sentence cleanly. A comma (A) creates a splice. No punctuation (B) is a run-on. A colon (C) would require the second clause to elaborate on '1978,' which it does not.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 128

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Inside the archive's humidity-controlled vault, there _____ a single drawer dedicated entirely to correspondence between the colony's first governor and the admiralty in London.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: are

B: were

C: is

D: have been

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'there _____' inverts the subject. The real subject is 'a single drawer' (singular, present). 'Is' is singular present. 'Are' and 'have been' are plural. 'Were' is past tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 129

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Since 1971, the Aland Maritime Museum has _____ a restored pilot cutter out of its boathouse every summer for visitors to board and explore.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: bring

B: bringing

C: brought

D: brung

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'has _____' requires a past participle. The correct form is 'has brought' (bring/brought/brought). 'Bring' is the base form. 'Bringing' is present participle. 'Brung' is nonstandard.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 130

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The reason the Hollister Reef dive site attracts so few recreational _____ its currents reverse unpredictably, and even experienced divers have been swept past the drop-off.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: divers, is simple,
- B: divers is simple
- C: divers is simple;
- D: divers is simple:

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the reason...is simple' forms a complete clause; what follows is the specifics of that reason. A colon introduces the elaboration. A semicolon (C) doesn't signal elaboration. No punctuation (B) is a run-on. Extra commas in A incorrectly break up the clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 131

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The canopy bridge, designed by wildlife ecologist Maura Goss and suspended across the motorway in _____ allows arboreal mammals to cross without descending to ground level.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: 2016,

B: 2016;

C: 2016:

D: 2016

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'designed by...and suspended...in 2016' is a nonessential participial phrase. The opening comma before 'designed' must be matched by a closing comma after '2016.' A semicolon, colon, or no punctuation fails to close the parenthetical properly.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 132

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: A number of regional museums _____ begun offering free admission on the first Saturday of each month, a policy that curators credit with doubling weekend foot traffic.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has

B: have

C: is

D: was

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'A number of' is an idiomatic expression meaning 'several' and takes a PLURAL verb. Contrast with 'THE number of,' which is singular. 'Have' is plural. 'Has,' 'is,' and 'was' are all singular.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 133

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Over the past decade, the concentration of dissolved nitrogen in the Felmark aquifer _____ steadily, prompting regulators to tighten fertilizer limits for farms above the recharge zone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: has risen

B: rose

C: rises

D: had risen

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'over the past decade' spans from the past to the present--present perfect is required. 'Has risen' (singular, matching 'concentration') is correct. 'Rose' is simple past (no present connection). 'Rises' is simple present. 'Had risen' is past perfect (needs a second past reference).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 134

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The city council praised the new transit hub as spacious, energy-efficient, and _____ to the surrounding residential blocks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: its design is sympathetic
- B: sympathetic in its design
- C: it has a sympathetic design
- D: with a sympathetic design

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the list is 'spacious, energy-efficient, and _____. Each item must be an adjective or adjective phrase to maintain parallel structure. 'Sympathetic in its design' is an adjective phrase matching the others. The other options are clauses or prepositional phrases that break the pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 135

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Noticing hairline fractures along the hull's waterline, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: an immediate dry-dock inspection was ordered by the surveyor.
- B: an immediate dry-dock inspection became the surveyor's priority.
- C: the decision was made to order an immediate dry-dock inspection.
- D: the surveyor ordered an immediate dry-dock inspection.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Noticing hairline fractures' requires a human subject who can notice. Only D starts with 'the surveyor'--a person. A and B start with 'an inspection,' C with 'the decision'--none can 'notice.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 136

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The lab's electron microscope, _____ can magnify structures up to 500,000 times, was donated by a pharmaceutical firm that had upgraded to a newer model.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: that

B: it

C: which

D: and it

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the clause is nonessential (extra info about the one microscope).

Nonessential clauses use 'which' with commas. 'That' is for restrictive (essential) clauses without commas. 'It' creates a comma splice. 'And it' would need restructuring.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 137

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The pottery workshop sets aside one Saturday a month for a _____ glazing class, in which participants shape and fire their own bowls.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: womens'

B: womens

C: women

D: women's

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'women' is an irregular plural (does not end in s). Possessive of an irregular plural = add apostrophe + s: 'women's.' 'Womens'' and 'womens' incorrectly add an s. 'Women' without apostrophe is not possessive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 138

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The dredger cleared the harbor mouth by early _____ the first cargo vessel entered the newly deepened channel later that same afternoon.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: morning,

B: morning, the

C: morning;

D: morning

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: two independent clauses with no conjunction. A semicolon joins them correctly. A comma (A) creates a splice. 'Morning, the' (B) is also a splice. No punctuation (D) is a run-on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 139

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The review board recommended that the university _____ its data-retention policy before the start of the fall semester to comply with the updated privacy regulations.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: revise

B: revises

C: revised

D: will revise

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'recommended that X [verb]' triggers the subjunctive mood--the verb is always the bare/base form regardless of subject. 'Revise' is correct, not 'revises' (indicative). The subjunctive ignores subject-verb agreement rules. 'Revised' and 'will revise' are wrong mood/tense.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 140

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Every stone in the monastery wall _____ cut from a single nearby quarry, a fact confirmed by geochemical analysis of the morite inclusions in the rock.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: were

B: was

C: are

D: have been

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'every' makes the subject singular regardless of what follows. 'Every stone...was cut' is correct. 'Were,' 'are,' and 'have been' are plural or wrong tense. Ignore 'inclusions' and other plural nouns in prepositional phrases.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 141

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The fellowship provides recipients with a monthly stipend, access to specialized laboratory equipment, and _____ from senior researchers in the fellow's chosen discipline.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: mentored

B: mentorship

C: to be mentored

D: mentoring them

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the list structure is 'a stipend, access, and _____. Each item must be a noun or noun phrase. 'Mentorship' is a noun matching 'stipend' and 'access.' 'Mentored' (past participle), 'to be mentored' (infinitive), and 'mentoring them' (gerund phrase) break the parallel noun pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 142

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: When performing Carnatic music, vocalists do not simply follow the written _____ they ornament each phrase with microtonal inflections drawn from a shared but unnotated tradition.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: notation; rather,
- B: notation, rather,
- C: notation, rather;
- D: notation, rather

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'rather' is a conjunctive adverb joining two ICs. It needs a semicolon before it and a comma after it. A comma before 'rather' (B, C, D) creates a splice. Only 'notation; rather,' uses the correct semicolon + comma pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 143

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In astrophysics, distinguishing short gamma-ray bursts from long ones--whether emitted by neutron-star mergers, collapsing stars, or magnetar flares--_____ among the field's most debated classification problems.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: remain

B: have remained

C: remains

D: remaining

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the subject is the gerund phrase 'distinguishing short gamma-ray bursts from long ones' (always singular). Strip the dash parenthetical. 'Remains' is singular. 'Remain' and 'have remained' are plural. 'Remaining' creates a fragment.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 144

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Scholars have long debated the intended audience of the two _____ opening chapters; one narrative addresses an unnamed patron while the other seems directed at the general reading public.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A: manuscript's respective
- B: manuscripts respective
- C: manuscripts's respective
- D: manuscripts' respective

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'two manuscripts' is plural. Plural possessive of a regular noun = apostrophe after s: 'manuscripts'.' 'Manuscript's' is singular possessive (one manuscript--contradicts 'two'). 'Manuscripts' without apostrophe is not possessive. 'Manuscripts's' is not standard.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 145

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: By the time the replacement pump arrived at the flooded mine in March, the water level _____ so high that crews needed an additional week just to make the tunnels accessible.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: had risen

B: has risen

C: rises

D: will have risen

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'by the time X happened' signals past perfect for the event that happened FIRST. The water rose before the pump arrived, so 'had risen' marks the earlier past. 'Has risen' is present perfect. 'Rises' is present. 'Will have risen' is future.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 146

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: To determine how drought alters soil microbiology, ecologist Ingrid Solheim's team collected weekly core samples from a test field. The plot _____ the field's driest quadrant, which had received no supplemental water since the previous autumn, yielded microbial communities strikingly different from those found in irrigated zones.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: comprised

B: comprises

C: had comprised

D: comprising

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'The plot comprising the field's driest quadrant...yielded.' 'Comprising' is a present participle forming a reduced relative clause. 'Comprised' or 'had comprised' would create two competing main verbs ('comprised...yielded') with no conjunction. 'Comprises' is present tense in a past narrative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 147

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The apprentice _____ the guild master selected for the commission had trained under three different ceramicists before arriving at the workshop, an unusual breadth of experience for someone so early in a career.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: who

B: which

C: whom

D: whose

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: the relative pronoun is the OBJECT of 'selected' ('the master selected [whom]'). Object case for people = 'whom.' 'Who' is subject case. 'Which' is for things. 'Whose' is possessive. Test: 'the master selected him' (object) confirms 'whom.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 148

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Two genera of deep-sea worms--Osedax, which consumes whale bone, and Lamellibrachia, which thrives at hydrocarbon _____ challenge the conventional image of the ocean floor as a barren environment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: seeps,

B: seeps--

C: seeps;

D: seeps

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: the opening '--' after 'worms' must be closed with a matching '--' after the last list item. 'Seeps--' closes the dash pair, allowing the main clause to resume. A comma, semicolon, or no punctuation would leave the dash pair unmatched.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 149

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The conclusion drawn by the panel was _____ the levee system's original designers had accounted for storm surge but not for the sustained fluvial flooding that caused the 2018 breach.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: sobering,

B: sobering:

C: sobering

D: sobering; that

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'The conclusion...was sobering' is a complete IC. What follows spells out the conclusion--a classic colon situation. A comma (A) creates a splice. No punctuation (C) is a run-on. 'Sobering; that' (D) misuses the semicolon before a subordinate 'that' clause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 150

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Grammar

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Theater historian Maren Aldiss's comprehensive study of the Globe Playhouse reveals that a single carpenter, Elias Poole, built most of the _____ trapdoors and stage machinery, yet not one of his contracts survives in the municipal record, a gap Aldiss attributes to the deliberate destruction of theatrical archives during the Interregnum.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: theater's

B: theaters

C: theaters'

D: theater

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'the Globe Playhouse' is one theater. Singular possessive = apostrophe + s: 'theater's.' 'Theaters' is plural. 'Theaters'' is plural possessive (multiple theaters). 'Theater' without apostrophe is not possessive.

END QUESTION